

CDN Incident Alert: 0055. TLP: CLEAR		Date
Title	DE Russian Pranksters prank call CDU MP Johann Wadephul, pretending to be Ukrainian Officials.	07/03/2025

Summary

- In January, the infamous Russian Pranksters Vladimir Kuznetsov and Alexei Stolyarov, published a video interview with CDU politician Johann Wadephul. The video was then re-surfaced on the 19th by an Alina Lipp-affiliated channel.
- The narrative seeks to smear the CDU, suggesting that the campaign promises that have been made are void once victory is achieved.
- The original video did not enjoy a wide reach in audience, as such, the sole observed impact has been the released statement by Johann Wadephul responding to the prank.
- The threat actors used tactics of smearing, impersonation, utilising true information for malicious purposes with the intent to drive voters away from voting for the CDU.
- Recommendations would suggest to continue monitoring and research the amplification mechanisms of the malicious content.

Incident

On January 29th, Russian Pranksters Vladimir Kuznetsov and Alexei Stolyarov published a video interview with Johann Wadephul on their Rumble and RuTube channels ([1](#), [2](#)). The video has relayed that the CDU wishes to have a coalition with the Green party and continue support for Ukraine post-election victory, unlike their promises made previously. The pranksters are infamous for targeting high level anti-Russian officials or activists. The two pranksters are responsible for similar shenanigans involving other prominent people such as Angela Merkel, John Lennon, Justin Trudeau and many others. Putin reportedly knows of the pranks ([3](#)). The pranksters were temporarily working on the Russian state media TV channel on a prank show, which included similar materials, which were streamed on the sanctioned state media channel NTV. The pranksters have admitted that they work for the Russian state-controlled company Gazprom-owned video platform Rutube ([4](#), [5](#)).

On February 19th, the prank video was translated to German and shared on the YouTube channel DruschbaFM, which claims to be affiliated with Alina Lipp and Sergey Filbert, owner of channel "Голос Германии" ([6](#)). DruschbaFM has likely communicated to the pranksters since the video which has been posted to the YouTube channel lacks the watermark present in the official release.

Alina Lipp has been known to have vague connections to the Russian state. Sergey Filbert, has a direct connection to the state, as he is known to be an election observer during the Luhansk and Donetsk referendum in 2022. He currently lives in Germany and owns the YouTube channel "Golos Germanii" (Voice of Germany) and has more than 500,000 subscribers. A sub-section of the channels content supports politicians from the AfD and leftists with close ties to Russia. Filbert was also allowed to report on his observer mission in Komsomolskaya Pravda, a Russian state press agency ([7](#), [8](#)). The initial response to the video was small, however, the amplification of the video posted to YouTube on February 19th was amplified by other users, some inauthentic. 78.1% of the posts mentioning the February 19th video were posted from 19.02.2025 to 21.02.2025.

Narrative

Meta narrative: The CDU are liars; The CDU plan to go against their campaign promises once victorious.

Sub-narratives: German public should consider alternative voting options.

Impact

The overall impact has been moderate, after compiling the total reach of the malicious material found across X at the time of report writing is 317,421 Views, 3530 retweets, 6611 likes, and 1682 favourites.

The outcome of the incident includes a public statement made by Johann Wadephul.

Key Objectives and Behaviours (DISARM Red Framework) (Max 2 objectives and 4 TTPs).

Objective: [T0135.001: Smear](#) - the threat actors hoped to obtain truthful information to misrepresent and use against the CDU, whom Wadephul is a representative of.

[T0143.003: Impersonated Persona](#) - Threat actors impersonated a Ukrainian official without disclosing their real identities.

[T0042: Seed Kernel of Truth](#) - The answers given by Wadephul have been truthful, albeit were not supposed to

be shared with the general public in the face of the ongoing campaign.
[T0048.001: Boycott/’Cancel’ Opponents](#) - With the help of the smear campaign, threat actors hoped to drive people away from voting for the CDU in the upcoming 2025 DE elections.

Recommendations and Actions Taken

Further monitoring and an in-depth study of the actors involved.
The amplification mechanism should be investigated further.

Report	Topic	Evidence	Authors	Platforms	Logo
N/A	German Election	Link	Debunk.org (authors). Saman Nazari, A4E (Editor).	X, Rumble, Youtube.	